

STATING REASONS AND USING EXAMPLES

PARAGRAPHS WITH REASONS AND EXAMPLES

When writing a paragraph of recommendation, you use reasons and examples to support your main idea. Here are the keys to writing a well-organized paragraph:

- State your recommendation in your topic sentence.
- Give several reasons for your recommendation. Your reasons tell why you are making the recommendation.
- Support each reason with examples.
- End with a concluding sentence restating your recommendation.

LOOKING AT THE MODEL

Highlight into the text to answer the following questions about the model

1. What is the controlling idea?
2. What are the writer's exact reasons?
3. What transition signal does he use to introduce each reason?
4. How many examples does the writer use to support each reason? What words signal each example?
5. Does the concluding sentence restate the recommendation or the reasons?
6. What organizational pattern does the writer use: space order, time order, or listing order?

Costa Rica: A Great Place to Study Wildlife

Costa Rica is a great place to spend a semester doing wildlife research for two reasons. First of all, this small country has very diverse¹ geography, so it has many different wildlife habitats. For example, Tortuguero National Park, on Costa Rica's northeastern coast, has more than ten different wildlife habitats, including rainforests, beaches, swamps, and canals. Students can study alligators in the swamps or observe sea turtles as they lay their eggs on the beaches. Another example is Corcovado National Park on the west coast. With its 13 different habitats, including an ancient rainforest, it is one of the most important nature preserves of the American continents. Second, Costa Rica has an astounding number of wildlife species². For instance, near the Arenal Volcano, there are 135 species of reptiles, including tortoises, snakes, and lizards, and over 250 species of birds live in the area. Another place with a rich variety of wildlife is Corcovado. There students can observe exotic animals, such as anteaters, spider monkeys, jaguars, and over 360 species of birds. Indeed, Costa Rica is a wonderful place to study if you love wildlife.

REASONS AND EXAMPLES

When you write a topic sentence such as *Costa Rica is a great place to spend a semester doing wildlife research*, you need to support it with **reasons** to help convince your readers. You then need to support your reasons with **specific examples**.

The author of the writing model gives two main reasons to explain why Costa Rica is a great place to spend a semester studying wildlife:

- It has very diverse geography, so it has many different wildlife habitats.
- It has an astounding number of wildlife species.

The writer supports each reason with two examples. The examples are specific facts about specific places. To support his first reason, he talks about the number and kinds of habitats in Tortuguero and Corcovado. To support his second reason, he mentions specific facts about the range and number of various wildlife species near Arenal Volcano and Corcovado.

PRACTICE 4

Identifying and Organizing Reasons and Examples

Use sentences a–h to complete the outline. (HINT: Identify the two reasons first and then the examples. The examples under each reason can be in any order.)

- a. A beach community offers recreation for residents of all ages.
- b. To enjoy the beach, people don't need to have anything special—just a swimsuit, a towel, and sunscreen.
- c. If you live near a beach, you can easily take a picnic lunch or dinner there.
- d. For adults, the beach is a great place to just relax or go for a walk.
- e. It costs very little money to enjoy time at the beach.
- f. Teenagers can do sports, such as surfing and volleyball.
- g. Often the parking is free or residents can get parking stickers.
- h. Children love to splash in the water, jump in the waves, and play in the sand.

TITLE	Living in a Beach Community		
TOPIC SENTENCE	There are two reasons why beach communities are great places to live.		
1ST REASON	A.		
EXAMPLES	1.		
	2.		
	3.		
2ND REASON	B.		
EXAMPLES	1.		
	2.		
	3.		
CONCLUDING SENTENCE	To sum up, beach communities offer great recreation at low prices.		

TRANSITION SIGNALS THAT INTRODUCE REASONS

When you use reasons to support a topic sentence, you should introduce each one with a **transition signal**. There are two patterns that you can use to do this:

PATTERN 1: First of all, _____.

In addition, _____.

This pattern uses a listing-order transition signal at the start of each reason:
first, first of all, first and foremost, second, secondly, furthermore, moreover, additionally, finally, lastly.....

First of all, this small country has very diverse geography, so it has many different wildlife habitats.

In addition, Costa Rica has an astounding number of wildlife species.



PATTERN 2: The first reason is _____.

Another benefit is _____.

Some other phrases also follow this pattern: *The first benefit, Another reason, An additional drawback, The last advantage, The final disadvantage.....*

There are two ways to complete a sentence that uses this pattern:

- With a noun phrase¹:

The first reason is **diverse geography and many wildlife habitats**.

Another benefit is **Costa Rica's astounding number of wildlife species**.

- With a noun clause² (*that* + subject + verb)

The first reason is **that Costa Rica has a diverse geography and many wildlife habitats**.

Another benefit is **that Costa Rica has an astounding number of wildlife species**.

PRACTICE 6**Using Transition Signals to Introduce Reasons**

Here are three reasons to visit San José, the capital of Costa Rica. Rewrite each reason twice: first, with a listing-order transition signal, and then with a transition signal in the subject.

Reason 1: San José has a pleasant climate.

- a. First, San José has a pleasant climate.
- b. The first reason is that San José has a pleasant climate.
- c. _____

Reason 2: Hotels and restaurants are inexpensive.

- a. _____
- b. _____
- c. _____

Reason 3: The people are friendly to tourists.

- a. _____
- b. _____
- c. _____

TRANSITION SIGNALS THAT INTRODUCE EXAMPLES

There are three transition signals that you can use to introduce examples: *for example*, *for instance*, and *such as*. Notice these patterns:

PATTERN 1: **For example,** (+ sentence)

For instance, (+ sentence)

Writing Tip

Be careful when you begin a sentence with *For example* or *For instance*. Make sure your sentence follows either Pattern 1 or Pattern 2.

When your example is a complete sentence, begin the sentence with *For example* or *For instance*. These two transition signals have exactly the same meaning. Put them at the beginning of the sentence and follow them with a comma.¹

For example, Tortuguero National Park has more than ten different wildlife habitats.

For instance, Tortuguero National Park has more than ten different wildlife habitats.

PATTERN 2: _____, **such as** (+ nouns)

_____, **for example** (+ nouns)

_____, **for instance** (+ nouns)

When your example is one or more nouns that appear at the end of a sentence, precede it with *such as*, *for example*, or *for instance*. Note these rules:

- Put a comma before *such as*.

Students can observe exotic animals, **such as** anteaters and spider monkeys.

- Put a comma before and after *for example* and *for instance*.

Students can observe exotic animals, **for example**, anteaters and spider monkeys.

Students can observe exotic animals, **for instance**, anteaters and spider monkeys.

Do NOT Do THIS:	Do THIS:
The restaurant specializes in shellfish. For example, fresh lobster and crab.	The restaurant specializes in shellfish. For example, it serves fresh lobster and crab. (PATTERN 1)
	The restaurant specializes in shellfish, such as fresh lobster and crab. (PATTERN 2)
	The restaurant specializes in shellfish, for example, fresh lobster and crab. (PATTERN 2)

A Add commas to the sentences.

1. Denmark has many children's attractions, such as Tivoli Gardens and Legoland.
2. Japan is famous for its beautiful gardens. For example the rock garden of Ryoanji Temple is known all over the world.
3. In São Paulo, there is a mix of architecture. You can see traditional architecture in some buildings for example the Martinelli Building and the Banco do Estado de São Paulo.
4. There are also many modern buildings in São Paulo. For instance the Banco Sumitomo and Conjunto Nacional are very modern in design.
5. Bolivia offers tourists many interesting places to visit for instance the capital city of La Paz and the islands in Lake Titicaca.

B Complete the sentences with *for example*, *for instance*, or *such as*. Add commas where needed. For some, there may be more than one answer.

1. Like many big American cities, San Francisco has several ethnic neighborhoods _____ North Beach (Italian), the Mission District (Hispanic), and Chinatown (Chinese).
2. When you visit the ethnic neighborhoods of Miami, you feel that you are in a foreign country. _____ in Little Havana you can easily imagine that you are in Cuba.
3. Summers are much cooler in San Francisco than in Los Angeles. _____ the average July temperature in San Francisco is about 65 degrees Fahrenheit, but it is 85 degrees Fahrenheit in Los Angeles.
4. Mexico's Yucatán Peninsula has many luxury beach resorts _____ Cancún and Cozumel.
5. The Yucatán is full of archeological treasures _____ the Mayan ruins at Chichén Itzá and Tulum.

CONCLUSION SIGNALS

PATTERN 1: For these _____ reasons, (+ sentence).

For these two reasons, Costa Rica is a wonderful place to study if you love wildlife.

PATTERN 2: Because of (noun phrase), (+ sentence).

Because of its diverse habitats and many animal species, Costa Rica is a wonderful place to study if you love wildlife.

PRACTICE 8 Using Conclusion Signals

Use the Ideas given in the outline to write the conclusion in 2 ways

TITLE	The Best Restaurant in Town
TOPIC SENTENCE	Joe's Diner is the best restaurant in town.
1ST REASON	A. The food is delicious.
EXAMPLES	1. Joe's double cheeseburger is juicy and full of flavor. 2.
2ND REASON	B. The service is fast and cheerful.
EXAMPLES	1. 2.
3RD REASON	C. The prices are low.
EXAMPLES	1. 2.
CONCLUDING SENTENCE	Pattern 1: Pattern 2:

COMPLEX SENTENCES WITH REASON CLAUSES AND CONDITION CLAUSES

REASON SUBORDINATORS	EXAMPLES
because	Europeans are in some ways better environmentalists than North Americans because they are more used to conserving energy.
since	Since many Europeans live, work, and shop in the same locale, they are quite accustomed to riding bicycles, trains, and streetcars to get around.
as	As the price of gasoline has always been quite high in Europe, most Europeans drive high-mileage automobiles that use less fuel.

B Use your own ideas to complete the dependent clause of reason or condition in each sentence.

1. I enjoy traveling because I like to learn about new cultures.
2. Since _____, I usually take the train.
3. I will take a special trip next year if _____.
4. Because New York City is very expensive, _____.
5. Since _____, I want to see as much of the world as possible.
6. I have to travel now because _____.

- A** Use a word from the box to combine the sentences in each group into a single simple, compound, or complex sentence. For some, there may be more than one answer.

and	but	since	that	while
because	if	so	when	

MY LOVE-HATE RELATIONSHIP WITH TRAVELING

1. a. There are two reasons I love traveling for work.
b. There are two reasons I hate traveling for work.
2. a. I work as a salesperson.
b. I have to travel out of town for a week once a month.
3. a. First of all, I love traveling for work.
b. Traveling for work allows me to meet new people.
c. Traveling for work allows me to go to new places.
4. a. For example, I am interested in history.
b. I try to set aside some time to visit a local historical site.
c. I try to set aside some time to walk around the downtown area.
5. a. Second, I feel energized
b. I feel challenged.
c. I am on my monthly sales trips.
6. a. On the other hand, traveling for work can be difficult.
b. Sometimes I hate traveling for work.
7. a. The first reason is this.
b. I don't sleep well in hotels.
8. a. I often watch TV late into the night.
b. I can't fall asleep.
9. a. As a result, in the morning I'm very tired.
b. By afternoon I need a nap.

10. a. The second reason I hate traveling is this.
b. I miss my family.
11. a. Our sons are very young.
b. They don't understand why I am away.
c. They want to talk to me every night.
12. a. I am away for an entire week.
b. It is hard on my sons.
c. It is hard on my wife.
d. It is hard on me.
13. a. I get a promotion next year.
b. I will have a sales area closer to home.
c. I won't have to do overnight trips.
14. a. In conclusion, I have a love-hate relationship with traveling.
b. I try to stay positive.
c. I try to focus on the good things.

B Write the new sentences from Part A as a paragraph.

My Love-Hate Relationship with Traveling

There are two reasons I love traveling for work and two reasons I hate it.

- A** Work with a partner. Use your imagination to add reasons and examples to the outline. Write two specific examples for each reason. Use complete sentences.

TITLE	The Best Restaurant in Town
TOPIC SENTENCE	Joe's Diner is the best restaurant in town.
1ST REASON	A. The food is delicious.
EXAMPLES	1. Joe's double cheeseburger is juicy and full of flavor. 2.
2ND REASON	B. The service is fast and cheerful.
EXAMPLES	1. 2.
3RD REASON	C. The prices are low.
EXAMPLES	1. 2.
CONCLUDING SENTENCE	Indeed, if you're looking for great food, amazing service, and reasonable prices, Joe's Diner is the place to go.